

KF Mini-Meeting Lesson 10

--"MINI-MEETING" FORMAT-- (20 min)

I - MINDFULLNESS (4 min)

-ANB (1 min)

-3 Minute Breathing Space (3 min)

II - CHECK-IN (10 min)

-KF Member "A" shares (5 min)

(1) What I learned

(2) Signs of MO

(3) Signs of Orientation

(4) Five things I am thankful for

-KF Member "B" shares (5 min)

(1) What I learned

(2) Signs of MO

(3) Signs of Orientation

(4) Five things I am thankful for

III - KF MEETING "PREVIEW" (6 min)

-Bible Teaching -- selected excerpt of previous week KF Bible teaching (5 min)

-Ending Prayer (1 min)

BIBLE TEACHING

If you have your Bible with you, turn to the second chapter of Paul's letter to the Philippians.

In this letter, Paul wants to remind us of the glory that we abandon when we choose the Idol Self. The Bible tells us what our glory looks like and feels like, and it describes the results of living in that glory, but we don't believe what the Bible says. We have not been encouraged or trained to understand that the glory described for us in the Bible can be experienced now, today, here on earth. The problem is a little more sinister than that, however. We have imagined a glory that we think is better than the one designed for us by our Creator. It takes humility and courage to give up the pursuit of fulfilling our imagined glory and, like Jesus, to take up the form of a servant and pursue our real glory.

This is Nancy's translation, with some paraphrase, of **Philippians 2:5–11**.

⁵Think within yourselves as Christ Jesus did, ⁶who, though in the form of God from the beginning, led the way in not grasping for that prize of equal footing with God. ⁷Instead He emptied or stripped Himself of the form of God and took the form of a slave, becoming just like other people with creaturely limitations, and was discovered by everyone to look just like a human being. ⁸He humbled Himself, becoming obedient right up to His death, the death of the cross, perhaps the humblest death of all. ⁹Therefore, God super-exalted Him, much more than He could have done had He tried to exalt Himself, and God *karissed* to Jesus the Name above all names; that is, His own reputation and authority, perhaps God's greatest gift, ¹⁰in order that at the name of Jesus every knee should bow—the knees of every heavenly and earthly being and of those in the underworld—¹¹and every tongue should make grateful acknowledgements, with the giving of thanks, that the Lord, the Name above all names, is Jesus Christ; and all of this adds to the glory of God the Father.

Take a deep breath.

We can follow Jesus to real glory if we will choose to have the same attitude that He had. He really was God, but, unlike our Idol, He did not snatch at being God. Like a bond-servant, we can take on humility

and choose to come under training. We can come down from the lofty illusions of our imagined glory and become obedient to God, to the point of what often feels like death—for that is what it takes. Obedience will feel very much like the death of our dreams for idealized fulfillment. But when our training in humility is complete we too will experience a resurrection. God will take over the exalting part and will help you, even you, to become more than you ever dreamed possible. This is not just storytelling. We see it happening in Karis Fellowships every week.

Last week we learned that when we live out of the True Self, several things happen:

1. We live in continual correspondence, or circulation, with the created world and the Creator.
2. We become truly creative creatures, helping to bring the glory of God into this world.
3. We explore what Paul meant when he wrote to Timothy: “The mature outcome of our message is love from a clean heart and mind, from a good moral co-understanding with God, and an authentic, active trust.”

The True Self has been birthed by God through the Holy Spirit living in us, and when we produce the Fruit of the Spirit in our lives, we reveal our family heritage. We can learn to nurture the production of this Fruit just as we can learn to nurture the produce of a garden. When fruit is ripe, the harvest feeds us and everyone around us.

Producing fruit, whether in a garden or in our lives, does not happen overnight. A harvest of fruit requires the investment of preparation, training, time, and resources. The real business of the True Self is to provide an environment that eventually produces the Fruit of the Spirit. You are a new creation in Christ. You are no longer compelled to conform to the world with all of its conflicts, fears, and cravings, or to old family systems that promote and maintain futile ways of life. You do not need to perpetuate the fears, misoriented choices, and secrets of your forefathers. Nothing changed until Jesus came to do something new. You are doing something new. It is not easy to do new things, but nothing will change unless you do.

Our prayer might go something like this:

Lord and Creator, help me become something new. (Repeat)

Take a deep breath.

ENDING PRAYER

Dear Father and Creator,

We are so grateful for this time together. Hold us in the power of this new direction as You guide us to our glory and to the truth. Lead us to the next step in our healing this week as we continue to reorient our lives to a more effective flow, to furthering our connection to our True Self and design, to our community and the rest of Creation, and to You, for the glory and honor of our Lord Jesus. Amen.

Take a deep breath.